STATE PENSION · CREDITS FOR FAMILY CARERS

Looked after a grandchild? You may be owed a pension year.

The parent who claims Child Benefit gets a full year of National Insurance with it. If they already have that year from their own earnings, it does nothing for them — and it can move to you, if you did the childcare.

WHAT A YEAR IS WORTH

£241.30

The State Pension is built out of years. 35 full years buys the full rate, £241.30 a week today. Under 10 years buys nothing at all.

> You can claim for every year back to 6 April 2011. The child has to have been under 12.

WHO GAINS NOTHING

1

If you worked that year and already have a full National Insurance year, there is nothing to gain — years do not count twice. And there is one credit per Child Benefit claim: if grandad takes it, grandma cannot.

> You had to be over 16 and under State Pension age at the time you did the caring.

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Not sure whether you have gaps?

Message us and we will tell you what to look for in your National Insurance record. The claim is form CA9176, signed by the parent as well.

0330 133 1886

General information. For your own situation, speak to an accountant.